

Is Your Android Device Safe and Secure?

With the Android OS gaining in popularity, your Android device could become the target of malware, and you could lose highly sensitive data to strangers. The same could happen if your device is stolen or misplaced. Read on to learn a few ways in which you can secure your Android device.



In October 2003, four youngsters (Andy Rubin, Rich Miner, Nick Sears and Chris White) dreamed of creating mobile devices that were smart enough to learn the users' location and preferences, and serve them accordingly. Android Inc was their effort at fulfilling this dream. Little did they know that 10 years down the line, their dream would turn the mobile industry upside down.

In 2007, the Open Handset Alliance (OHA) declared Android as a free open source operating system for mobile devices. This meant that technology companies like Samsung, Sony, HTC, LG, etc—who were all, at that time, struggling to gain a foothold in a market primarily dominated by Nokia—got a new breath of life. They could now use the stock Android ROM as the base OS and customise it for their devices.

In no time, since the launch of HTC Wonder, the mobile

device market across the world was flooded with Android-based mobile devices, and the wild popularity of tablets and phablets gave Android a nitro boost. Another factor that added to the popularity of Android was its Linux-based kernel, which gave it the flexibility to be used with other devices (such as TVs, set-top boxes, etc). As of the second quarter of 2013, approximately 80 per cent of the smartphones across the world are running on the Android operating system.

Why secure your Android device?

Fool-proof systems or technologies exist only in an ideal world. In the real world, no system or technology is fool-proof. It will always have some vulnerability or the other. The chances of such loopholes being discovered grow in direct proportion to the popularity of the technology. Android is an example of this.